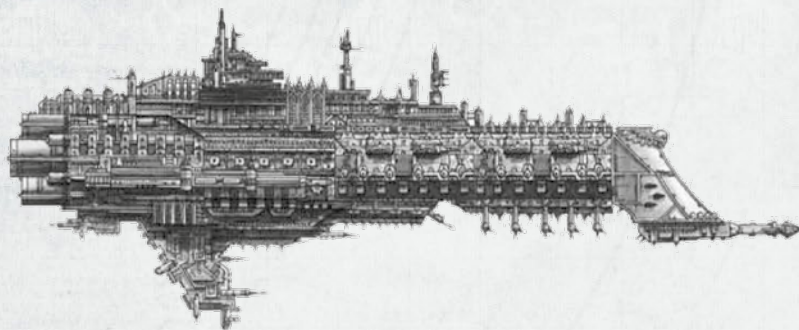


Famous Ships of the Gothic War: Invincible, Emperor's Wrath, Righteous Fury, Sword of Orion



TYPE/HITS	SPEED	TURNS	SHIELDS	ARMOUR	TURRETS
Cruiser/8	20 cm	45°	2	6+ front / 5+	2
ARMAMENT		RANGE/SPEED	FIREPOWER/STR		FIRE ARC
Port lance battery		30 cm	4		Left
Starboard lance battery		30 cm	4		Right
Prow torpedoes		30 cm	6		Front

The powerful Gothic class cruiser is a familiar sight throughout the Imperium, with numerous vessels operating in each of the Segmentum battlefleets. A potent force in its own right, the class carries the heaviest lance array of any Imperial cruiser in the Gothic sector, making it a deadly adversary for enemy vessels of all sizes. However, in the course of the war it became apparent that it could only operate successfully in the company of other vessels, after two encounters between the *Righteous Fury* and the Chaos grand cruiser *Bloodied Sword*. In each case the *Righteous Fury* barely escaped after suffering severe damage and scoring only a handful of hits on the enemy vessel. Powerful as the lances were, they could not damage an opposing vessel fast enough in duels. A change in tactics, pioneered by Captain Hodge of the *Righteous Fury*, saw Gothic class ships paired with their own squadron of escorts or another cruiser. They would then engage an enemy vessel abeam, while its supporting ships circled to attack from bow or stem. This used the heavy lance armament to good effect, by knocking down the enemy's shields and allowing its consorts to attack, while preventing its enemy from moving away. Using its new tactics, the Gothic class cruiser made a valuable contribution to the war by destroying the Chaos cruisers *Cackling Hate* and *Glorious Bloodbath* in its later stages.

FLEET LISTS

Gothic Sector Fleet List (pg. 33), Bastion Fleets List (pg. 34), Armageddon Sector Fleet List (pg. 38), Bakka Sector Fleet List (pg. 46), Adeptus Mechanicus Fleet List (pg. 122)